

Alice Morgan

Staff platform engineer · reliable systems, thoughtful teams

I turn growing software platforms into systems that teams can understand and operate. My work joins hands-on engineering, pragmatic architecture and patient mentoring. I care about useful defaults, clear ownership and the experience of the person on call.

Experience

Staff platform engineer, Northstar Atlas
Mar 2023 – present
Bristol · hybrid
A fictional mapping software company supporting research teams and civic services. Led the platform group as the product grew from a regional service into a shared service for twelve partner organisations.

- Replaced a single shared release window with independently deployable services, reducing the median time from a reviewed change to production from two days to forty minutes.
- Designed a versioned ingestion API with idempotent writes and explicit retry behaviour. Worked with partner engineers to migrate each client without a coordinated cutover.
- Introduced service ownership, measurable reliability goals and short incident reviews. The approach gave product teams a common language for choosing between new work and operational improvements.
- Built a small paved road for deployments, secrets and observability. Kept the underlying tools accessible so teams could investigate failures without waiting for platform support.
- Coached six engineers through design reviews and production investigations; rotated facilitation so knowledge and decision-making did not depend on a single person.

Python · PostgreSQL · Kubernetes · OpenTelemetry

Senior software engineer, Cedar Post
Feb 2020 – Feb 2023
Remote
Built dispatch and tracking tools for a fictional cooperative of independent delivery services. Owned the data path from mobile updates to customer-facing tracking.

- Split a fragile nightly import into resumable stages with a visible progress log. Operators could replay a failed stage without reprocessing successful deliveries.
- Added contract tests and consumer-driven migration plans around the public tracking API, then removed obsolete endpoints once every active client had moved.
- Reworked the operations dashboard with dispatchers during weekly observation sessions. Made delays, stale device updates and missing addresses visible before a customer called.
- Documented recovery procedures as executable commands with expected output. A new engineer could restore the staging service and explain what each step protected.

Go · Redis · event processing · accessible interfaces

Contact

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Engineering notebook

Education

MSc, Computer Science
Westbridge Institute of Technology
Sept 2015 – June 2017

- Research project on understandable failure reports in distributed applications.

BSc, Mathematics
Alder College
Sept 2012 – June 2015

Software engineer, Meadow Instruments
July 2017 – Jan 2020
Bath, United Kingdom
Developed a fictional laboratory scheduling product with a small multidisciplinary team.

- Implemented a reservation service that accounted for equipment maintenance and shared preparation time, with explicit validation of conflicting bookings.
- Added audit history and a read-only export for laboratory coordinators. Clear error messages reduced support requests around incomplete booking forms.
- Paired with the support team to turn recurring reports into regression tests and concise troubleshooting notes.

TypeScript · Python · SQL

Projects

Harbour observability handbook
A fictional community guide for teams establishing their first on-call rotation, Jan 2025 – present

- Wrote runnable examples that connect user-visible symptoms to logs, traces and service metrics. Each chapter ends with a short investigation rather than a list of product features.
- Tested the handbook with volunteer maintainers and revised the examples around the decisions readers found hardest to make.

Open documentation · mentoring

Community repair weekend
A two-week volunteer programme coordinating repairs and sharing practical maintenance skills, May 2024

- Built a lightweight intake board with clear repair status, printable labels and an accessible public view.

Skills

Systems
Python
Go
PostgreSQL
Kubernetes
eBPF
OpenTelemetry
Redis

Practice
API design
incident analysis
incremental migration
technical writing
contract testing
release planning

Reliability
Service objectives
Recovery exercises
Capacity planning
Alert design
Runbook writing
Failure analysis

Collaboration
Design reviews
Pair programming
Workshop facilitation
Decision records
Knowledge sharing
Team onboarding

Strengths
Patient mentoring
Clear communication
Calm decision-making
Thoughtful feedback
Shared ownership

Languages

English: Native

French: Professional working proficiency

Selected Writing

Make recovery a normal operation
A fictional essay on testing restoration before an incident, Apr 2026

- Explains why a small rehearsed recovery procedure can be more useful than a long document that has never been run. Includes a checklist for ownership, required access and verification.

The smallest useful platform
A fictional conference session about choosing a narrow platform scope, Sept 2025

- Uses a case study to show how an internal platform can standardise routine work while preserving a clear escape hatch for unusual workloads.